Unit IV

Group Behavior:

- **Definition and classification of Groups**
- **Types of Group Structures**
- **Group decision making**
- **Teams Vs Groups**
- **Contemporary issues in managing teams**
- **Inter group problems in organizational group dynamics**
- **Management of conflict.**

MEANING AND DEFINITION OF GROUP

A group consists of two or more persons who interact with each other, consciously for the achievement of certain common objectives. The members of the group are inter-dependent and are aware that they are part of a group.

Groups or work teams are the primary tools used by managers. Managers need groups to coordinate individual behavior in order to reach the organizational goals. Group can make a manager's job easier because by forming a group, he need not explain the task to each and every individual. A manager can easily coordinate with the work of a an individual by giving the group a task and allow them to coordinate with each other. But for a group to work effectively, the interactions between its members should be productive. Therefore, managers must pay attention to the needs of individuals.

According to David H. Smith; "A group is a set of two or more individuals who are jointly characterized by a network of relevant communications, a shared sense of collective identity and one or more shared dispositions with associated normative strength".

According to Edgar H. Schien, "A group may be defined as social phenomenon in which two or more persons decided to interact with one another, share common ideology and perceive themselves as a group".

According to Marvin Shaw, "A group comprises, of two or more persons who interact with one another in such a manner that each person influences and is influenced by each other person". The key parts of this definition are the concepts of interaction and influence, which also limit the size of the group. It is difficult for members to interact sufficiently in a large group.

In order to be called a group, an aggregation of persons must satisfy the following conditions:

1) People must interact with one another,

2) People must be psychologically aware of one another, and

3) People should perceive themselves to be a group.

Groups are a fundamental part of social life. They can be very small-just two people – or very large. They can be highly rewarding to their members and to society as a whole, but there are also significant problems and dangers with them. All this makes them an essential focus for research, exploration and action. A group consists of a number of individuals working together for a common objective. Groups have significant influence on an organization as they form foundation of human resources. A group is a two or more individual who interact regularly with each other to accomplish a common purpose or goal.

Classification of Groups/Types of Group Structure

Groups may be classified into different types. The basis of differentiation may be purpose, extent of structuring, process of formation, and size of the group membership. Various types of group are as follows:

1) **Primary and Secondary Groups: Primary groups** are those characterized by intimate, face-to-face association and co-operation. These are clusters of people like families or close friendship circles were there is close, face to face and intimate interaction. There is also often a high level of interdependence between members. Primary groups are also the key means of socialization in society, the main place where attitudes, values, and orientations are developed and sustained. For example, family, and peer group.

Secondary groups are characterized by large size and individual's identification with values and belief prevailing in them rather than actual interaction. These groups are those in which members are rarely, if ever, all in direct contact. They are often large and usually formally organized. Trades unions and membership organizations such as the National Trust are examples of these. They are an important place for socialization, but secondary to primary groups.

2) **Membership Groups and Reference Groups:** Membership groups are ones to which the individual actually belongs. For example, clubs, co-operative societies, workers union, etc.

Reference groups are the one with which an individual identifies or to which he would like to belong.

3) **In-groups and Out-groups:** In-groups represents a clustering of individuals holding prevailing values in a society or at least having a dominant place in social functioning. For example, members of a team, family members, etc.

Out-groups are the masses or conglomerate viewed as subordinate or marginal in the culture. For example, street performers for an officer worker, a hawker for a surgeon.

4) **Interest and Friendship Groups: Interest group** involves people who may come together to accomplish a particular goal with which they are concerned.

Friendship groups are formed by people who have one or more common features. People coming from a particular regions or holding a particular viewpoint or speaking a particular language tend to form friendship groups.

5) **Formal and Informal Groups: Formal groups** are established by the organization to accomplish specific tasks. It is a designated work-group defined by the organizational structure. It includes:

(i) Command Groups: Command groups are composed of the subordinates who report directly to a common superior. For example, a college principal and teachers, a production manager and his subordinates in his department and so on.

(ii) Committees and Taskforces/Groups: Committees and taskforces are created to carry out specific organizational assignment or activities.

Informal groups are those groups, which appears in response to the need for social contact. These groups are formed within the structure of the organization but by the members themselves. They are formed to satisfy the social needs on the job.

6) **Temporary and Permanent Groups:** Groups are formed for achieving certain objectives. They have a very short life. After attaining the objectives, they are dissolved. Solving problems and discussing ideas are the main functions of temporary groups. Meetings, committees, and small groups are example of temporary groups.

There are certain natural and permanent groups. They have group activities, group performances, job assignments and so on. A team is a permanent group. Trade union and business associations are examples of permanent groups.

7) **Nominal and Non-performing Groups:** Nominal groups are presented with problems to be solved. Members of the groups share their ideas in a structured format. Their alternative suggestions are discussed for arriving at more effective suggestions. This is a nominal group because the employees are members of the group for name sake only.

Non-performing groups are only on paper. They are formed and developed without any performances. They have certain goals but there is no attempt to achieve those goals.

GROUP DECISION-MAKING

Introduction : Decision-making is an act of choice wherein an individual or a group selects a particular course of action from the available alternatives in a given situation. The basic characteristics of the group decision-making process are as follows:

1) It is a human process involving to a great extent the application of intellectual abilities.

2) It is a process of choosing a course of action from among the alternative courses of action.

3) Decision-making in business is always related to certain objectives.

4) It is the end process preceded by deliberation and reasoning.

5) It is always related to a situation. A managers may take one decision in a particular set of circumstances.

6) It involves some commitment, may be even for a short period.

Decision –making is at the core of managerial planning. It involves establishing goals, defining tasks, searching for alternatives and choice of the best alternative. In an organization, decision-making may be carried out by both individuals and groups. In modern organizations facing the environmental uncertainties, group decision-making has become almost indispensable.

In an organization, many decisions are made by individuals without taking the help of the group members while more decisions are made by group. Therefore, the question arises: what are the situations in which individual decisions should be preferred and what are the situations in which group decision should be preferred? Following is the analysis of situations for individual and group decisions:

1) **Nature of Problem:** If the policy guidelines are given, individual decision-making will result in greater creativity as well as more efficiency. Where the problem requires a variety of expertise, group decision-making is suitable.

2) **Acceptance of Decision:** Where organizational prescription makes it mandatory to go for group decision, the decision would be accepted only when it has been made by the appropriate group, for example, committee decision. In other cases also, group decision is more accepted for implementation.

3) **Quality of Decision:** Group decision-making generally leads to higher quality solutions unless an individual has expertise in the decision area and this is identified in advance.

4) **Climate of Decision-Making:** Supportive climate encourages group problem solving whereas competitive climate stimulates individual problem solving.

5) **Time Availability:** Group decision-making is a time-consuming process and, therefore, when time at the disposal is sufficient, group decision-making can be preferred.

Group Decision-Making Techniques

Group decision making techniques are as follows:

1) **Interacting Groups:** The most common form of group decision-making takes place in interacting groups. In these groups, members meet face-to-face and rely on both verbal and nonverbal interaction to communicate with each other. But interacting groups often censor themselves and pressure individual members towards conformity of opinion. Brainstorming, the nominal group technique, and electronic meetings have been proposed as ways to reduce many of the problems inherent in the traditional interactive group.

2) **Brainstorming:** Brainstorming is meant to overcome pressures for conformity in the interacting group that retard the development of creating alternatives. It does this by utilizing an idea-generation process that specifically encourages any and all alternatives, while withholding any criticism of those alternatives.

   In a typical brainstorming session, a half dozen to a dozen people sit around a table. The group leader states the problem in a clear manner so that it is understood by all participants. Members then "freewheel" as many alternatives as they can in a given length of time. No criticism is allowed, and all the alternatives are recorded for later discussion and analysis. That one idea stimulates other and that judgments of even the most bizarre suggestions are withheld until later encourage group members to "think the unusual."

   The four **basic rules** of brainstorming are as under:

   i) No criticism is allowed.

   ii) Freewheeling is always welcome. The wilder the idea the better it is. It is easier to jot down than to think up ideas.

   iii) Quantity is desirable.

   iv) Combination and improvements are sought from the members.

   Brainstorming, however, is merely a process for generating ideas. The following two techniques go further by offering methods of actually arriving at a preferred solution.

3) **Nominal Group Technique:** The Nominal Group Technique restricts discussion or interpersonal communication during the decision-making process, hence, the term nominal. Group members are all physically present, as in a traditional committee meeting, but members operate independently. Specifically, a problem is presented and then the following steps take place.

   (i) Members meet as a group but, before any discussion takes place, each member independently writes down his or her ideas on the problem.

   (ii) After this silent period, each member presents one idea to the group. Each member takes his or her turn, presenting a single idea until all ideas have been presented and recorded. No discussion takes place until all ideas have been recorded.

(iii) The group now discusses the ideas for clarity and evaluates them.

(iv) Each group members silently and independently rank-orders the ideas. The ideas with the highest aggregate ranking determines the final decision.

The chief advantage of the nominal group technique is that it permits the group to meet formally but does not restrict independent thinking, as does the interacting group.

4) **Electric Meeting:** The most recent approach to group decision-making blends the nominal group technique with sophisticated computer technology. It is called the computer-assisted group or electronic meeting. Once the technology is in place, the concept is simple, up to 50 people sit around a horse shoe-shaped table, empty except is simple, up to 50 people sit around a horse shoe-shaped table, empty except for a series of computer terminals. Issues are presented to participants and they type their responses onto their computer screen. Individual comments, as well as aggregate votes, are displayed on a projection screen in the room.

5) **Delhi Technique:** This technique is a modification of brainstorming technique, except that it involves obtaining the opinions of experts physically separated from each other and unknown to each other. Generally, the type of problems handled by this technique is not specific in nature or related to a particular situation at a given time. The process is more involved in predicting and assessing the impact on our society of future events in a given area. For example, the Delphi technique may be used to understand the problems that could be created in the event of a war and after.

Advantages of Group Decision-Making

Positive aspects of group decision making are as follows:

1) **Pooling of Knowledge and Information:** Since many individuals involved in group decision-making, more data and information can be brought to bear on the decision. The group provides specialized inputs in defining variables and suggests alternatives that the individual alone is unlikely to come up with.

2) **Satisfaction and Communication:** Individual satisfaction and comment in group decision-making are often enhanced. This may be caused by an attitude change regarding the alternatives a result of discussion. It may also be caused by the development of group spirit as people discover similarities among themselves.

3) **Personnel Development:** Group decision-making is a source of development of individuals in the organization. Learning is enhanced when one observes others, practices what has been seen, and experiences the positive rewards received for successfully repeating the new behavior.

4) **More Risk Taking:** Every decision involves some kind of risk because a decision affects future events and one can never be sure whether a particular decision affects future events and one can never be sure whether a particular decision varies in terms of rosk-taking aptitudes and capabilities, risk taking increases when these individuals are pooled in a group. This the risk taking tends to be higher in group decision making.

5) **Different Perspectives:** Individuals with varied experience and interests help the group to see decisions, situations, and problems from different angles.

Disadvantages of Group Decision-Making

Group decision-making has following negative features, which may either affect the quality of decision or cost of decision.

1) **Time-Consuming and Costly:** Inevitably, groups take more time to reach decisions than individuals.

2) **Individual Domination:** Because of the groups dynamics prevailing in group interaction, some individuals dominate the group processes and have considerable bearing on decision outcomes. This may be because such individuals may enjoy higher status because of their age, experience, expertise, or other influencing characteristics.

3) **Problem of Responsibility:** No doubt, group decision brings more commitment from members and its implementation is easier but this is true when the decision implementation outcome is positive. When this outcome is negative, no one can be held responsible.

4) **Groupthink:** "Groupthink" is type of thinking that occurs when reaching agreement becomes more important to group member than arriving at a sound decision. Groupthink is more like to happen in cohensive groups because there is pressure for conformity to group norms and members avoid being too harsh in their judgments of fellow members. They try to avoid bickering and conflict, which they perceive as a threat to the team spirit.

5) **Goal Displacement:** Sometimes, secondary considerations such as winning an argument, making a point, or getting back at a rival displace the primary task of making a sound decision or solving a problem.

TEAM VS GROUPS

Teams are groups of two or more people who interact and influence each other, are mutually accountable for achieving common goals associated with organizational objectives, and perceive

themselves as a social entity within an organization. All teams exist to fulfill some purpose, such as assembling a product, providing a service, designing a new manufacturing facility or making an important decision. Team members are held together by their interdependence and need for collaboration to achieve common goals. All teams require some form of communication so members can coordinate and share common objectives. Team members also influence each other, although some members are more influential than others regarding the team's goals and activities.

All teams are groups because they consist of people with a unifying relationship. But not all groups are team; some groups are just people assembled together without any necessary interdependence or organizationally focused objective. Along with formal work teams, an organization consists of informal groups. Informal groups are not initiated by the organization and usually do not perform organizational goals thus they are "informal"). Instead, they exist primarily for the benefit of their members. The groups a person meets for lunch and chats with in the hallway are informal groups. In each case, he associates with these groups for his own benefit.

Do you still members the excitement during the last world cup and the way the Indian team performed? No matter what they could finally achieve or not, we all used to comment on spirit of the Indian team. A team can be defined as a special type of group whose members have complementary skills and are committed to a common purpose or set of goals for which they hold themselves mutually accountable. In the recent times, a lot of emphasis is being given on developing teams. The importance of teams has long been appreciated in the world of sports, and now it is being used increasingly in the realm of business and industry as well. Though there are similarities between groups and teams, and these two terms are often used interchangeably, there are in fact a few striking differences between the two.

CONTEMPORARY ISSUES IN MANAGING TEAMS

Teamwork affects every business and every employee. It determines turnover and productivity and it defines the functionality of a business. While fundamental to a business' success, teamwork is difficult to harness as it is reliant upon several different factors (and personalities) working together.

The issues related to managing teams are as follows:

1) **Teams and Total Quality Management:** One of the central characteristics of Total Quality Management (TQM) is the use of teams. But why are teams an essential part of TQM?

   The essence of TQM is process improvement and employee involvement is the linchpin of process improvement. In other words, TQM requires management to give employees the encouragement to share ideas and act on what they suggest. As one author put it, none of the various TQM processes and techniques will catch on and be applied except in work teams. All such techniques and processes require high levels of communication and contact, response and adaptation, and coordination and sequencing. They require, in short, the environment that can be supplied only by superior work teams.

Ford began its TQM efforts in the early 1980s with teams as the primary organizing mechanism. Because this business is so complex, you cannot make an impact on it without a team approach, noted one Ford Manager. In designing its quality problem-solving teams, Ford's management identified five goals. The teams should:

i) Be small enough to be efficient and effective.

ii) Be properly trained in the skills their members will need.

iii) Be allocated enough time to work on the problems they plan to address.

iv) Be given the authority to resolve the problems and implement corrective action.

v) Each has a designated champions whose job it is to help the team get around roadblocks that arise.

2) **Team and Workforce Diversity:** Managing diversity on teams is a balancing act. Diversity typically provides fresh perspectives on issues, but it makes it more difficult to unify the team and reach agreements.

The strongest case for diversity on work teams is when these teams are engaged in problem-solving and decision-making tasks. Heterogeneous teams bring multiple perspectives to the discussion, thus increasing the likelihood that the team will identify creative or unique solutions. Additionally, the lack of a common perspective usually means diverse teams spend more time discussing issues, which decreases the chances that a weak alternative will be chosen. However, keep in mind that the positive contribution that diversity makes to decision-making teams undoubtedly declines over time. Diverse groups have more difficulty working together and solving problems, but this dissipates with time. Expect the value-added component of diverse teams to decrease as members become more familiar with each other and the team becomes more cohesive.

Studies tell us that members of cohesive teams have greater satisfaction, lower absenteeism, and lower attrition from the group. Yet cohesiveness is likely to be lower on diverse teams. So, here is a potential negative of diversity. It is detrimental to group cohesiveness.

The relationship between cohesiveness and group productivity was moderated by performance-related norms. It is suggested that if the norms of the team are supportive of diversity, then a team can maximize the value of heterogeneity while, at the same time, achieving the benefits of high cohesiveness. This makes a strong case for team members to participate in diversity training.

3) **Strengthen Mature Teams:** Mature teams are particularly prone to suffer from group-think. Members begin to believe they can read every one's mind so they know what everyone is thinking. As a result, team members become reluctant to express their thoughts and less likely to challenge each other.

Another source of problem for mature teams is that their early success is often due to having taken on easy tasks. It is normal for new teams to begin by taking on those issues

and problems that they can handle most easily. But as time passes, the easy problems become solved and the team has to begin to confront more difficult issues. At this point, the team has typically developed entrenched processes and routines, and members are reluctant to change the perfect system they have already worked-out. The results can often be disastrous. Internal team processes no longer work smoothly. Communication bogs down. Conflicts increase because problems are less likely to have obvious solutions. And team performance can drop dramatically.

What can be done to reinvigorate mature teams? These offer four suggestions:

i) Prepare Members to Deal with the Problems of Maturity: Remind team members that they are not unique in all successful teams have to confidence in the team concept when the initial euphoria subsides and conflicts surface.

ii) Offer Refresher Training: When teams get into ruts, it may help to provide them with refresher training in communication, conflict resolution, team processes, and similar skills. This can help members regain confidence and trust in one another.

iii) Offer Advanced Training: The skills that worked with easy problems may be insufficient for more difficult ones. So, mature teams can often benefit from advanced training to help members develop stronger problem-solving, interpersonal, and technical skills.

iv) Encourage Teams to Treat their Development as a Constant Learning Experience: Like TQM, teams should approach their own development as part of a search for continuous improvement. Teams should look for ways to improve, to confront member fears and frustrations, and to use conflict as a learning opportunity.

INTER GROUP PROBLEMS IN ORGANISATIONAL GROUP DYNAMICS

Groups working in organizations face two major problems, one they perform effectively, i.e., contribute positively to organisational goals and fulfil their member's needs. Second, how to create and sustain conditions between groups which enhances the productivity of each without hampering inter group relations and coordination. This problem emerges as groups as groups become more committed to their own goals and norms and start competing with one another and undermining rival's activities. Consequently, they become liability for organization as a whole. Challenge before managers is to develop collaborative inter group relations where task interdependence or the need for unity becomes pre-condition for organizational effectiveness.

1) Group Challenges: What were the key adaptive challenges that early humans faced living in groups and what mechanisms could have evolved to solve these? Based on the literature, six critical group challenges identified are as follows:

i) Coordinating group activities (coordination),

ii) Exchanging resources (social exchange),

iii) Negotiating group hierarchies (status),

iv) Keeping groups together (group cohesion),

v) Making collective decisions (collective decision-making), and

vi) Interacting with members of out-groups (inter group relations).

2) **Inter group Conflict:** Inter group conflict can be highly competitive, especially for social groups with a long history of conflict. In contract, inter group competition can sometimes be relatively harmless, particularly in situations where there is little history of conflict (e.g., between students of different universities) leading to relatively harmless generalizations and mild competitive behaviours. Inter group conflict is commonly recognized amidst racial, ethnic, religious, and political groups.

According to Social Identity Theory, inter group conflict starts with a process of comparison between individuals in one group (the in-group) to those of another group (the out-group). This comparison process is not unbiased and objective. Instead, it is a mechanism for enhancing one's self-esteem. In the process of such comparisons, an individual tends to – favour the in-group over the out-group exaggerate and over generalize the differences between the in-group exaggerate and over generalize the differences between the in-group and the out-group (to enhance group distinctiveness) minimize the perception of differences between in-group members to evaluate the ingroup more favourably remembers more detailed and positive information about the in-group, and more negative information about the out-group.

Even without any inter group interaction (as in the minimal group paradigm), individuals begin to show favoritism towards their own group, and negative reactions towards the out-group. This conflict can result in prejudice, stereotypes, and discrimination.

Inter group conflict may be caused by competition for resources, goal incompatibility, time incompatibility, and contentious influence tactics. There are activities in which organizations can participate in order to reduce or prevent competition between groups. Some factors related to this issue are as follows:

(i) Competition for Resources: Most organizations today have very limited resources. Groups within the organization compete for budget funds, space, supplies, personnel, and support services.

(ii) Task Interdependence: If two groups in the organization depend on one another in a mutual way or even a one way direction (as in a sequential technological process), there tends to be more conflict than if groups are independent of one another. The more desire the objectives, priorities, and personnel of the interdependent group **for example,** research and production), the more conflict there tends to be.

(iii) Jurisdictional Ambiguity: This may involve "turf" problems or overlapping responsibilities. **For example,** conflict might occur when one group attempts to assume more control or take credit for desirable activities, or give up

its part and any responsibility for undesirable activities.

(iv) Status Struggles: This conflict occurs when one group attempts to improve its **status** and another group views this as a threat to its placed in the status hierarchy. One group may also feel it is being inequitably treated in comparison with another group of equal status in terms of rewards, job assignments, working conditions, privileges, or status symbols. Human resources departments, justifiably often feel they are treated inequitably in relation to marketing, finance, and operations departments.

(v) Goal Incompatibility: It occurs when the goals of two or more groups are in direct opposition such that one group will achieve its goal while the other group(s) will be unable to meet the goal. Goal incompatibility may be distinguished between real goal incompatibility and perceived goal incompatibility.

(vi) Time Incompatibility: Workgroups perform different tasks, have different goals, and interact with different customers such that groups will have different timeframes or deadlines in which they operate.

(vii) Contentious Influence Tactics: Contentious influence tactics (e.g., threats, demands, and other negative behaviours) may be used to attempt to influence others from another group creating cycles of retaliation and influencing the opinions of those within their own group (e.g., creating bad reputations).

3) Inter group Competition: What happens in inter group competition within and between competing has been first studied by **Sherif** and his colleagues. The same experience is observed in other replications in different kinds of groups at various locations. Inter group competition can be as much a problem for a team as is individual competition.

The problem of competition leading to conflict and hostility is more pronounced in the inter group situation. Groups are more likely to act competitively with each other than are individuals. One explanation for this comes from social identity theory, according to which a person's sense of self-worth is connected to the groups to which he or she belongs. Consequently, it becomes necessary to view one's group as superior. This leads to an in-group bias, in which group members view their own group in overly positive terms and out-groups in overly negative terms. When the superiority of the group is challenged, members rally to support it and attack the out-group. The conflict escalates easily because group behavior is more anyoneymous with fewer interpersonal connections between members and the out-group.

MANAGEMENT OF CONFLICT

In many cases, conflict in the workplace just seems to be a fact of life. There are situations where different people with different goals and needs have come into conflict. The fact that conflict exists, however, is not necessarily a bad thing. As long as it is resolved effectively, it can lead to personal and professional growth.

In many cases, effective conflict resolution skills can make the difference between positive and negative outcomes.

Procedure for Resolution of Conflict

Following steps must be taken in resolving a conflict already arisen:

1) **Preliminary Step:** This step involves knowing of full detail of the conflict and the first things to note is the stage of conflict. The more advance the stage of conflict, the more efforts are required to resolve it. Moreover strategy used is also dependent upon the stage of conflict.

2) **Diagnosing the Issue:** Under this stage, the issues involved should be analyzed and understood what the conflict is about. It may arise due to facts, goals, methods and values. Next thing in diagnosing is to know why these differences have arisen. The difference may be informal, perceptual, role factors and the like.

3) **Conflict Handling Modes:** There may be numerous modes of conflict handling and these have been grouped into five;

   (i) To Avoid Appearance of Conflict and for this purpose like-minded people should be appointed.

   (ii) Not Permitting Conflicts to Surface, i.e., to suppress the feelings of the parties causing frustration to both the parties. Under this approach, leader is supreme and loyalty to group and to leader is desired.

   (iii) Mediation: It involves sweeping out differences by mediation through persuasion, highlighting the merits and demerits of their case.

   (iv) Letting the Parties to Settle their Scores: It is better when both the parties adopt a rigid stand to their views.

   (v) Mutual Problem Solving: This approach is suitable when both parties are interested in resolving the conflict and are not rigid to their stand.

Conflict Resolution Strategies

The various strategies for resolving conflict :

1) **Strategies for Resolving Intra-Personal Conflict:** Intra-personal conflict arises from frustration, competing roles, or goals having positive or negative aspects. To the extent that conflict from frustration results out of blocked goal realization, removal of barriers (covert or overt) will help resolve this conflict. It is the manager's responsibility to clear his employee's path for advancement in his career.

i) The well-known theory of cognitive dissonance helps the individual resolve the approach-approach conflict. In simple terms, dissonance is the state of psychological discomfort or conflict created in people when they are faced with two or more goals or alternatives to a decision.

ii) Avoidance-avoidance conflict may be resolved by examining and solving the problems causing the conflict.

iii) Role conflict can be resolved by minimizing the number of roles and fixing priorities for them. Once priorities are determined, there must be no overlapping of roles.

iv) Much of the intra-personal conflict in an organizational members can be resolved by developing compatibility between his or her personal and organizational goals.

2) **Resolving Inter-Personal Conflict:** The strategies suggested for reducing intra-personal conflict will be useful to resolve inter-personal conflict also. The additional approaches to resolve inter-personal conflict are:

i) **Lose-Lose:** In a lose approach to conflict resolution, both parties stand to lose. This approach can take several forms. One of the approaches is to pay-off one of the parties to a dispute. A third approach is to involve a third party as an arbitrator. The final approach is for both parties to resort to existing regulations or bureaucratic rules to resolve the conflict.

ii) **Win-Lose:** In this strategy one party to the conflict tries to marshal all the resources to win, and other party loses. Examples of win-lose strategies can be fund in superior-subordinate relationships, line-staff confrontations, union management relations.

iii) **Win-Win:** A win-win strategy of conflict resolution is probably the most desirable from the human and organizational standpoint. Energies and creativity are aimed at solving the problems rather than beating the other party. The needs of both parties in the conflict situations are met, and both parties receive rewarding outcomes.

iv) **Transactional Analysis:** Inter-personal conflict can be resolved by encouraging as many complimentary transactions as possible between parties to the conflict. Of more significance for conflict management is the adult to adult transaction between the parties. Interaction between two adults ego states will improve communications.

v) **Altering the Behavioural Inputs:** Finally, inter-personal conflict may be resolved by focusing on the behavior of the individual involved. Conflict arises out of the perceptions and attitudes of people. These can be changed through training programs. T-group or sensitivity training assumes relevance in this context.

3) **Resolving Intra Group Conflict:** Conflict within a group can be resolved if the members recognize and respect roles of group members. All the members need to realize that divided they stand, united they fall. Probably, an outside party may intervene to resolve the dispute if the members fail to resolve the conflict themselves.

4) **Resolving Inter Group Conflict:** The approaches available for resolving intra-personal and inter-personal conflicts can be used to solve inter group disputes too, they are problem solving, organization redesign, super ordinate goals, expansion of resources, smoothen, avoidance etc.

However, certain unique approaches are available for resolving inter group conflict. They are: problem solving, organization redesign, super ordinate goals, expansion of resources, avoidance, smoothen, negotiation, member exchanges, inter group team development, reducing the need for inter group interaction, resource allocation process.